

Philipp Hilbert. *Operational product owner for complex technical software.*

Positioning, nearly ten years translating complex operational workflows into dev-ready requirements, now applying that to PBX and VoIP product delivery.

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Dear Starface hiring team,

I am applying for the Product Owner PBX Software role. My background is nearly ten years of hands-on product ownership across technically complex, operationally intensive software systems – AI data platforms for European defence programmes, InsurTech SaaS serving primary insurers and reinsurers, public-sector analytics infrastructure, and a quantum-encryption startup I co-founded. The common thread is translating ambiguous, high-stakes requirements into structured backlogs that development teams can actually execute against.

The challenge your job description centres on – owning the operative delivery of PBX products across cloud, on-prem, and hybrid deployment variants while keeping requirements quality high and communication transparent – matches the operating mode I have maintained across my last three engagements. At Emil Group I inherited a 17-person team in a prototype-stage environment with eroded sprint discipline and near-total senior developer attrition. I split the team into smaller Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices, rebuilt the client relationship through weekly product workshops, and stabilised delivery within two months. At Rohde & Schwarz I delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end – user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout – in a programme with multinational stakeholders and strict data provenance requirements. Both situations demanded exactly what your posting describes: strong backlog ownership, clear prioritisation across value, stability, and technical feasibility, and reliable communication between development and business units.

I do not have a direct PBX or VoIP background, and I want to name that honestly. What I have demonstrated repeatedly is the ability to internalize a new technical domain quickly and contribute meaningfully within weeks rather than months. The Linux-based, multi-deployment-model architecture that defines your product portfolio is conceptually close to the Kubernetes-based, multi-environment systems I have managed; the product ownership mechanics – understanding deployment constraints, balancing feature work against operational stability, coordinating with support and QA on live issues – transfer directly.

My working language preferences align well with your requirements. German is my native language; I communicate at C2 level in English and am comfortable in mixed-language technical environments. I am based in Berlin and open to discussing on-site arrangements in Karlsruhe.

I would welcome a conversation about the current state of the backlog and where the most immediate gaps are. That is usually the fastest way for both sides to assess fit.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
